

faults, but it was crucial to the people of the region. Among other things, it was famous for leaving its passengers stranded, because the couplings between its wagons and carriages, which had to be connected manually, often came accidentally undone. The railway would go on to find its way into the reminiscences of authors Amiya Kumar Das and Liladhar Barua who wrote in *Asomat Mahatma* of one such incident in 1921 involving Mohandas Karamchand Gandhi.

Translating the text, author Arup Kumar Dutta wrote: “We learnt that ... the coach carrying the Mahatma had been left behind! When the train stopped we all got down for a look. True, that coach had been left way behind! We were terrified – the soul of the nation was in that coach and we were responsible for him. And we had left him behind in the dead of the night in an unfamiliar spot with none to ensure his safety!” Gandhi, had a good laugh and told his companions that “he had despaired that the train would ever come back for him.”



Insignia of the Assam Bengal Railway